



**made in
USSR**

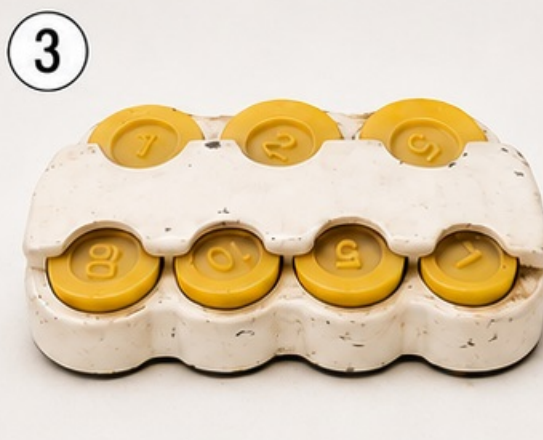
Match the Soviet **appliances** with the pictures below.

- A. Bread box
- B. Laundry tongs
- C. Soda siphon
- D. Pencil sharpener
- E. Vacuum cleaner

- F. Berry picker
- G. Egg beater
- H. Coin sorter
- I. Washboard
- J. Stereoscope

- K. Hair dryer
- L. Laundry machine
- M. Meat grinder
- N. Glass holder
- O. Dumpling mold

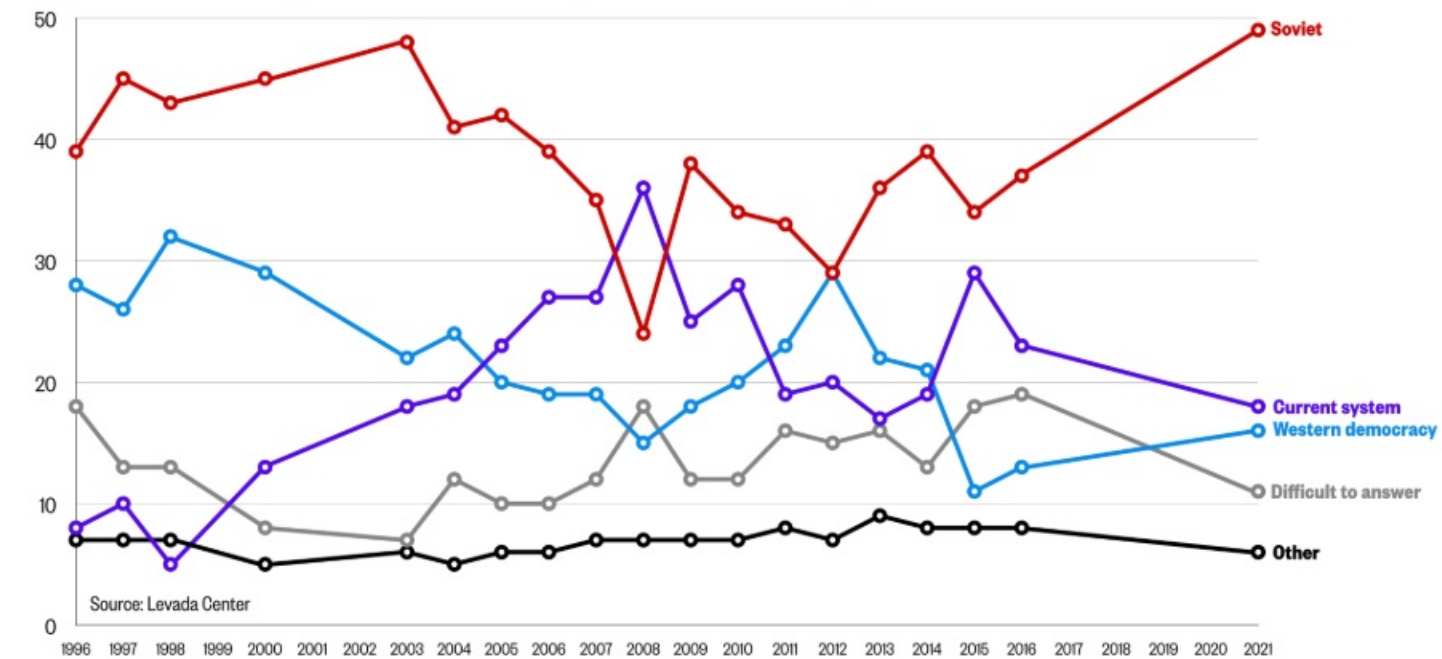
Have you ever used or seen any of these appliances? What have they been replaced by?



Nostalgia for the Soviet Union Hits 14-Year High in Russia, Poll Says

75% of Russians Say Soviet Era Was 'Greatest Time' in Country's History – Poll

Which political system do you think is best?



r/AskARussian • Cinderpath

Is there nostalgia for Soviet Union times?

Culture

I have three questions about how people feel about the older Soviet Union times.

1. Are people in Russia are sometimes nostalgic for the old Soviet Union days, and if so are they mostly older people who lived through them?
2. What are younger people's impressions of those times, even though they didn't live through it?
3. Are TV or media programs from this time period popular, or is there an interest in it?

I ask because I find nostalgia an interesting thing in cultures. Some people in the former East Germany have this too, there is even an interesting word for it called "Ostalgie" which means "Nostalgia for former GDR times", even though they know it is unrealistic to return to such a scenario. This is also the case for some Americans who long for the time period after the WWII when America was the dominant super power. Trump tapped into these voters emotions. As time goes by however younger generations care less about this, and are also critical that it was only good times for white citizens.

Nostalgia is often connected with emotions from our own past and youth, and not necessarily associated political events, etc, but simpler, less complex times.

But other countries there is no real, or large sense of nostalgia. Such as in China, because people are happy with their situation now, and for them these are "The good old days", and people are focused on the future. I'm curious about a Russian perspective?

My personal belief is that living too much in the past can be a distraction, and if unchecked can be a dangerous thing, and sometimes prevents real progress from happening. Thank you for your responses.



1. Were schoolchildren forced to write only with red ink to support communist ideology?



3. Did people really stand in enormous lines just to buy toilet paper?



8. Were summer camps available for many children through schools?



9. Did every Soviet apartment look exactly the same?



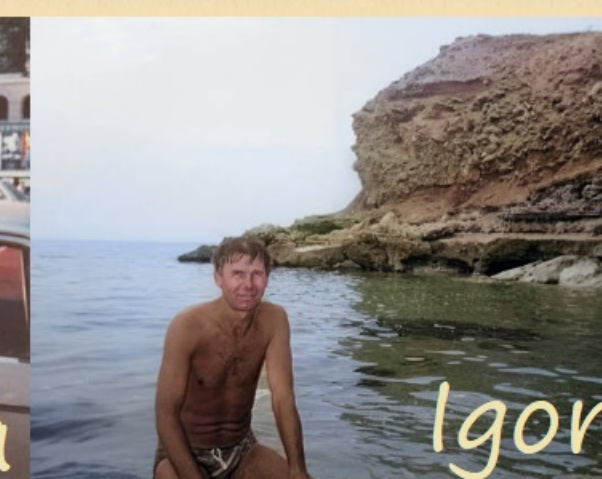
2. Were Western jeans, chewing gum, and rock music really considered rare and exciting?



7. Was life financially safer and more stable?



4. Was every schoolchild expected to join communist youth groups?



You are going to hear three people who were born in the USSR talking about their childhoods and everyday life in the Soviet Union on a podcast. The speakers answer questions asked by young people today. **Listen carefully and match each question (1–9) with the correct speaker.**



5. Were stores actually completely empty all the time, with almost nothing available to buy?

6. Is it true that the government could give families a free apartment?

“Humans always adapt.”
 “I felt very grown-up when I first wore the red scarf.”
 “My mother loved books, flowers, and music.”
 “Sunny Tashkent forever in my heart.”
 “Forbidden things always become more interesting.”
 “I am a little nervous because of my English.”
 “We played football outside until dark.”
 “Sometimes I read things online and think, ‘Were we living in the same country?’”
 “My father walked around the apartment like he owned a palace.”

WHO SAID IT?

What memories do you have of your childhood, and how do you feel about them today?